NOVEMBER 2007

# Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

**P.O. Box 252**
**Mountain View, CA 94042**
**Trudi Tuban - Editor**




Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

## *ORAL HISTORY STORIES BY ROBERTA BUBB SWEENEY, DORIS AWALT EBERE AND ANNE BAKOTICH PRESENTED BY HONOR SPITZ SUNDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2007 AT 2PM*

### *INTRODUCTION BY WALLY ERICHSEN*

**Three long standing Twentieth Century residents of Mountain View, all recently deceased, tell stories of their early days in the city. We will watch a video with their "oral histories." Our new Program and Publicity Chairperson, Honor Spitz, will set the stage for this presentation.**

### *PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE BY ROBERT WEAVER*

**This fall has been very exciting and productive. Under Eugene Sharp's leadership, we hosted an Eagle Shack Reunion that brought together many old friends for a smashing party at the Adobe Building. There was great coverage in the Mountain View "Voice" regarding the event and from what I observed, everyone had a great time.**

**I just spent the day at a conference on "Building Museums," hosted by the Western Museums Association, which was at the De Young Museum in San Francisco. I was able to make some solid contacts and acquire information that will help guide us along in the establishment of our new museum. A museum**

steering committee of business leaders and community leaders has been formed and will soon meet giving us the benefit of their professional expertise and experience during this formative development period.

A welcome to Honor Spitz who replaces Wallace Erichsen as Program and Publicity chair for our Association. Please take time to meet Honor and offer your suggestions for future programs, at our November meeting. See you there.

## *OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN*

*125 Years Ago (1882):* Republican nominees for county offices were welcomed at the train station and escorted to Margot's Hall with a band, anvil salutes and bonfires. The Hall was decorated with flags, flowers and "even canary birds scattered throughout the room." A banquet followed the speeches.

*100 Years Ago (1907):* Barbers in Mountain View got together and agreed to raise the cost of hair cuts to 35 cents.

Mr. Sanguinetti, of the Sanguinetti Canning Company, will be planting the Bailey property at Castro Street and San Francisco Road to tomatoes next season.

*75 Years ago (1932):* New businesses in Mountain View included the State Market at 124 Castro; McCormick Heating and Sheet Metal at 143 Castro and Ugo Mancini's Flying A Service Station, at the corner of Castro and Church Street, with Phil Rice as Manager.

Honors for local boys: Henry Norman, a baritone, was elected to sing in the famous Pomona College Glee Club. Gordon Chandler and Dick Glyer were winning praise as actors. Glyer was lead in a Eugene O'Neill play at San Jose State.

Snow fell in Mountain View on December 11, 1932, for the first time in the 30 years since newspaper editor, Pop Smith, has lived here. The grammar school was closed the following day as many children were "home sick."

Work at the Air Station is almost half complete. The helium tank will be the largest structure of its kind in the world.

Jesse Grant, son of Ulysses S. Grant, President from 1869-1876, lives in Los Altos.

***50 YEARS AGO (1957):*** **The Asian Flu epidemic caused closure of schools and the cancellation of many gatherings.**

**Carl E. Anderson, owner of Anderson Sand and Gravel Company, and Mountain View's first Eagle Scout (31 years ago), presented an Eagle Scout pin to his own son, Carl Anderson, Jr.**

**The Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Association erected and dedicated its Wild Cherry tree marker at Grant and Cuesta on land owned by the Bubb family. This tree was used as a Witness tree to establish boundary lines.**

***25 YEARS AGO (1982):*** **The City Council endorsed a proposal for a five to ten acre "Mountain View 80th Birthday Grove" of redwood trees in Big Basin.**

**Mr. and Mrs. Tony Bondi were the first subscribers to use cable TV in Mountain View.**

**Rengstorff House, sitting up on blocks in Shoreline Park, awaiting permanent placement and restoration, has been again vandalized in spite of a protective chain-link fence with barbed wire.**

**A 12 year-old boy was charged with throwing lighted matches at 81 year-old Mrs. Shina Shigemura of Kittoe Drive and setting her clothing and hair on fire.**

**Almost completed at NASA-Ames, the $85 Million new addition to the world's largest wind tunnel was seriously damaged during a test. Diverter vanes broke up and fragments damaged fan blades and motors. It may take more than a year to repair the $12 Million in damages.**

## *STREET TALK BY BARBARA KINCHEN*

**Leong Drive honors Samuel Leong, Sr., who opened the Moffett Food Center in 1950 at or near Highway 101 and Moffett Boulevard. Mr. Leong was born in China, at age nine came to Arizona with family and then to the Bay Area in 1947. He was active in Kiwanis and the Chamber of Commerce and in 1974 was named the Chamber's Citizen of the Year. Mr. Leong died at age 81 at Anacordes, Washington in 1993.**

## *NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW LIBRARY'S HISTORY CENTER BY BARBARA KINCHEN*

***From member Lou Beck:*** **Information about the Eagle's Shack organizing committee and the first dance, from the "Mountain Eagle" (the High School's newspaper); a membership card and two snapshots. One identifies Mark Stiver and Roger Hollway with a background of dancers. The second features Jack Young playing sax and Denver Groff on trumpet.**

***From Helen Forester:*** **A menu from Andy's Chinese Restaurant, 174 Castro Street.**

***From member Fern McLaggan:*** **Photo of a Castro Street barbershop showing three barbers and their customers. Fern's father, Ray Wright, is the middle barber. His shaving brush and mug were also given.**

***From members Ruth and Wallace Erichsen:*** **A small 96 page booklet of letters sent home to their family while on a year-long trip to Europe in 1984-1985.**

## *ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE*

| | |
|---|---|
| **President** | **Robert Weaver** |
| **Vice President** | **Vivian Schatz** |
| Sergeant at Arms | Craig Holden |
| Secretary | Margaret Peterson |
| Treasurer | Pat Figueroa |
| Past President (not active) | Nick Galiotto |
| Editor | Trudi Tuban |
| Membership | June Casey |
| Programs & Publicity | Honor Spitz |
| Hospitality | Laura Brown |
| Memorials & Remembrances | Edna Thompson |
| Ways & Means | Hip Telmont |
| Historical Data | Barbara Kinchen |
| Amplification & Recording | Al Jehning |

## *MVHA'S INCOME AND EXPENSE STATEMENT*

| | |
|---|---|
| **Beginning Balance as of July 15, 2007:** | **$21,379.16** |
| **Income: $12,491.24** | |
| **Expenses: $19,169.43 **** | |
| **Ending Balance as of September 24, 2007:** | **$14,700.97** |

****Includes 2 new certificates of deposit**

## *MEMBERSHIP REPORT BY JUNE CASEY*

| | |
|---|---|
| A/S = Single Members | 121 |
| A/F = Family Members | 122 |
| LM = Life Members | 122 |
| HM = Honored Members | 2 with 367 TOTAL |

**New A/S Members:** Patricia Hirschbek and Ray C. Mathies

**Reinstated A/S:** Rick Espinosa and John Cortez

**New A/F Members:** Cornell and Charlotte Anton (correction to Aug. Newsletter)
Renato and Josephine Del Carlo
Bonny and Dudley Wright

## *IN MEMORIAM*

JAMES MAXWELL (MAX) BELLEW passed away September 9, 2005 at age 87. He graduated from the Mountain View Union High School in February 1937. He is survived by his daughter, Maxine Graham.

JUANITA MURDOCK CAMP passed away July 9, 2007 at age 88. in Knoxville, TN. She married (Wilbur) Reynolds Camp in 1942 and they moved to Mountain View after WWII. Preceded in death by her husband and twin brother Stanley Murdock. Survived by her brother, Bruce Murdock and her three children, Denis R. Camp, David G. Camp and Elaine Camp Johnston. Juanita was a 61 year member and past president of the PEO, Chapter HE, and a member of the MVHA.

## *QUESTIONNAIRE REGARDING THE NEWSLETTER FORMAT*

Do you prefer "straight text format" (currently being used) or do you prefer a "column format" as is used in newspapers?

Do you like the larger (14 point) type that we use when space is available (rather than 12 point)?

The Editor would appreciate your response. See a place to mark your preference in the membership renewal form on page 7.

We needed a filler page so that the "mail in coupon" for your payment of 2008 dues matched up to the last page.

You must be familiar with Mountain View in the time period 1935 to 1975 to understand why the Editor might "make it hail for three weeks" by putting a Chevy ad in the newsletter.



## *IT IS TIME TO RENEW YOUR MEMBERSHIP FOR 2008*

**The form below is to fill out and send in for your 2008 membership dues. We deeply appreciate your timely payment.**

**Please check the address sticker on your newsletter. If it says AS or AF07, you owe dues for 2008. If it says LM, you are a Life Member and do not owe dues.**

**Note: If it says AS or AF06, please send dues for both 2007 and 2008! We do not want to loose you as a member.**

**Remember, a membership to the Mountain View Historical Association makes a great gift.**

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**/ / Prefer straight text format / / Prefer column type format**

**/ / Prefer 12 point type / / Prefer 14 point type**

MEMBERSHIP OR RENEWAL APPLICATION

**NAME:**
**ADDRESS:**

**TELEPHONE:**

***TYPE:*** **NEW_____ RENEWAL_____**
**Regular Member $10/year**
**Family Membership $15/year**
**Life Member $200.00**
***Make Check Payable to:***
**Mountain View Historical Association**
**P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042**

**Mountain View**

**Historical**

**Association**

***ORAL HISTORY***

***STORIES OF***

***THREE LOCAL WOMEN***

***Sunday, 11/4/2007***

***2 PM***

***THE ADOBE BUILDING***

***CORNER OF CENTRAL***

***ESPRESSWAY &***

***MOFFETT BLVD.***

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

**MEMBERSHIP OR RENEWAL APPLICATION**

NAME:
ADDRESS:

TELEPHONE:

*TYPE:* NEW_____ RENEWAL_____
Regular Member $10/year
Family Membership $15/year
Life Member $200.00
*Make Check Payable to:*
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